

Explanation of Florida Criminal Record (1995–1996)

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1. Charge: Obstruction of Justice / Police Obstruction

In 1995, I was present when my underage cousin was detained for shoplifting a pack of cigarettes. I asked the police where they were taking her. For this, I was charged with "obstruction," even though my only involvement was making an inquiry about her safety and whereabouts.

2. Charge: Possession of Drug Paraphernalia

While being transported in the back of a police car, I was additionally charged with possession of drug paraphernalia. The item in question was a glass pipe that was already present in the vehicle before I was placed inside. I had no knowledge of it and no connection to it, but the charge was added regardless.

3. Subsequent Drug Testing and Abuse of Authority by a Physician

Because of these prior charges, I was required to undergo periodic drug testing. During this process, the doctor overseeing the tests abused his position of power. He threatened that my children would be taken away and demanded sexual acts in exchange for not reporting false results.

4. Cooperation with Law Enforcement

I reported this abuse to the police and agreed to cooperate with an investigation. I wore a recording device during a subsequent appointment and obtained audio evidence of the doctor's coercion. Following this, law enforcement intervened and arrested him. He was later convicted, sentenced to 15 years in prison, and served 5 years.

TESTIMONY OF JESSICA COLLINS

Re: Explanation of Florida Criminal Court Records (1996–1997)

I, Jessica Collins, hereby submit this sworn statement to clarify the nature of certain Florida court records that may appear under my name. These records reflect situations in which I was a **victim of abuse and misconduct** rather than a perpetrator of crime.

1. Police Obstruction (1996)

This charge arose when my underage cousin was detained for shoplifting. I asked the police officers where she was being taken. My inquiry was treated as "obstruction," and I was charged, though I committed no act of resistance or interference.

2. Possession of Drug Paraphernalia (1996)

While being transported in a police vehicle, officers charged me with possession of a glass pipe. The pipe was already in the police car before I entered, and it was not mine. Nevertheless, the charge was placed against me.

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3. Abuse During Court-Ordered Drug Testing (1996–1997)

As a condition of probation, I was required to submit to periodic drug tests under the supervision of counselor Joseph G. DeMaio. DeMaio abused this authority, threatening me with the loss of my children and with falsifying urine test results unless I submitted to sexual acts. I was coerced and intimidated into compliance.

4. Cooperation with Law Enforcement

I reported DeMaio's misconduct to law enforcement. At great personal risk, I agreed to cooperate in an undercover investigation by wearing a recording device to my counseling sessions. My cooperation led to DeMaio's arrest in July 1997.

5. Prosecution and Conviction of DeMaio

The State of Florida charged DeMaio with multiple counts of sexual misconduct by a psychotherapist, extortion, bribery, and sexual battery. I was the primary victim and witness. DeMaio was convicted and sentenced to 15 years in prison, of which he served 5.

Conclusion

The Florida court records connected to my name do not represent criminal actions that I committed. They are the result of my victimization by a state-appointed counselor and my subsequent cooperation with authorities in bringing him to justice.

I respectfully request that these circumstances be fully considered in the evaluation of my asylum claim.

Declaration

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States that the foregoing is true and correct.

Signed: _____

Date: _____